

BUSINESS ANALYSIS PROJECT
Customer Service Process Improvement
Ubuntu Retail

Industry: **Retail / E-commerce**

Role: Business Analyst

Project Type: Digital Process & System Improvement

Portfolio Case Study

Naomi Mohlala

naomimohlala2@gmail.com

<https://naomimohlala.github.io/portfolio/>

1. Business Case

1.1 Business Problem

Ubuntu Retail is experiencing delays in its customer service process. Customer support tickets are taking too long to receive a response and resolve, resulting in customer dissatisfaction, frequent escalations, and inefficient manual processes.

1.2 Current Performance

Metric	Current Performance
Average response time	18 hours
Average resolution time	42 hours
First-contact resolution	54%
Escalation rate	22%
Customer satisfaction	71%

1.3 Project Objective

The objective of this project is to improve Ubuntu Retail's customer service process by reducing response and resolution times, increasing first-contact resolution, reducing unnecessary escalations, and improving overall customer satisfaction.

1.4 Target Performance

Metric	Target
Average response time	< 6 hours
Average resolution time	< 24 hours
First-contact resolution	75%
Escalation rate	< 10%

Metric	Target
Customer satisfaction	85%+

1.5 Expected Business Benefits

- Faster customer response times
- Faster issue resolution
- Fewer unnecessary escalations
- Improved customer satisfaction
- More efficient support operations
- Better visibility into unresolved customer issues

2. Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholders are individuals or groups affected by the customer service process or involved in improving it.

Stakeholder	Role / Interest	Influence	Key Needs
Customers	Submit support requests	High	Fast and accurate resolution
Customer Service Agents	Handle customer issues	High	Easy access to customer information
Team Leaders	Manage support teams	High	Performance and SLA visibility
Operations Manager	Oversees customer service operations	High	Efficient processes and reduced costs
IT Team	Supports and implements the solution	High	Clear technical requirements
Finance	Handles refunds and payment issues	Medium	Accurate financial information
Warehouse	Handles stock and delivery issues	Medium	Accurate order information

Stakeholder	Role / Interest	Influence	Key Needs
Senior Management	Approves business improvements	High	Improved customer satisfaction and efficiency

2.1 Key Stakeholder Priorities

The most important stakeholders for this project are:

1. **Customers** — need faster and more effective support.
2. **Customer Service Agents** — need the right information and tools to resolve issues.
3. **Team Leaders** — need visibility into ticket volumes, escalations, and performance.
4. **Operations Manager** — needs measurable improvements in efficiency.
5. **IT Team** — needs clear and complete requirements to implement the solution.

3. Problem Statement & Business Objectives

3.1 Problem Statement

Ubuntu Retail's current customer service process relies on manual ticket assignment, inconsistent escalation procedures, and limited access to customer and order information.

As a result, customer support tickets take too long to resolve, some tickets are transferred unnecessarily, and customers do not always receive timely updates.

3.2 Business Objectives

The project aims to:

1. Reduce the average customer response time from **18 hours to less than 6 hours**.
2. Reduce the average resolution time from **42 hours to less than 24 hours**.
3. Increase first-contact resolution from **54% to 75%**.
4. Reduce the escalation rate from **22% to below 10%**.

5. Increase customer satisfaction from **71% to at least 85%**.
6. Improve visibility of unresolved and escalated customer tickets.
7. Reduce unnecessary manual processes within customer support.

3.3 Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful when the agreed target KPIs are achieved and the improved customer service process is consistently being followed by the relevant teams.

4. Requirements

Requirements describe what the improved customer service solution must be able to do.

4.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-001	The system must allow customers to submit support tickets.	High
FR-002	The system must automatically categorise support tickets.	High
FR-003	The system must assign a priority level to each ticket.	High
FR-004	The system must automatically route tickets to the appropriate department.	High
FR-005	Customer service agents must be able to view customer information and order history.	High
FR-006	Agents must be able to update ticket status.	High
FR-007	The system must notify customers when their ticket status changes.	Medium
FR-008	The system must notify supervisors when a ticket is approaching its SLA deadline.	High
FR-009	Supervisors must be able to view unresolved and escalated tickets.	High

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-010	The system must generate customer service performance reports.	Medium

4.2 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
NFR-001	The system should be available during business operating hours with minimal downtime.	High
NFR-002	Customer information must be protected from unauthorised access.	Critical
NFR-003	Common system actions should respond within 3 seconds.	Medium
NFR-004	The system should support multiple customer service agents simultaneously.	High
NFR-005	The system should maintain an audit trail of ticket updates.	High

5. User Stories

User stories describe what different users need from the proposed solution and why they need it.

US-001 — Submit Support Ticket

As a customer,

I want to submit a support ticket online,

so that I can request assistance without contacting the company by phone.

Acceptance Criteria

- Customer can submit a support ticket.
- Customer must provide the required information.
- A unique ticket number is generated.
- Customer receives confirmation after submission.

US-002 — Categorise Support Ticket

As a customer service agent,
I want support tickets to be automatically categorised,
so that tickets can be handled by the appropriate team.

Acceptance Criteria

- A category is assigned when a ticket is created.
 - The category can be reviewed by an agent.
 - Incorrect categories can be updated.
-

US-003 — View Customer Information

As a customer service agent,
I want to view customer and order information from the ticket,
so that I can resolve customer issues without requesting information repeatedly.

Acceptance Criteria

- Customer details are displayed.
 - Relevant order history is displayed.
 - Information is available from the support ticket.
 - Only authorised employees can access the information.
-

US-004 — Automatic Ticket Routing

As a team leader,
I want tickets to be automatically routed to the correct department,
so that tickets are handled without unnecessary transfers.

Acceptance Criteria

- Tickets are routed according to their category.
 - The assigned department is visible.
 - Tickets can be manually reassigned when necessary.
-

US-005 — SLA Monitoring

As a team leader,

I want to receive alerts when tickets are approaching their SLA deadline,
so that I can act before the SLA is breached.

Acceptance Criteria

- The system monitors ticket deadlines.
- A warning is generated before the SLA deadline.
- Team leaders can view tickets approaching their SLA.
- Escalated tickets are clearly identified.

6. As-Is Process

6.1 Current Customer Service Process

The current process relies heavily on manual ticket handling and communication between departments.

Process Flow

1. Customer submits complaint

↓

2. Customer Service receives ticket

↓

3. Agent reviews ticket

↓

4. Agent determines whether they can resolve the issue

↓

5A. If YES → Agent resolves issue

↓

Customer is notified

↓

Ticket is closed

5B. If NO → Agent escalates ticket

↓

Ticket is sent to another department

↓

Department investigates issue

↓

Issue is resolved

↓

Customer is notified

↓

Ticket is closed

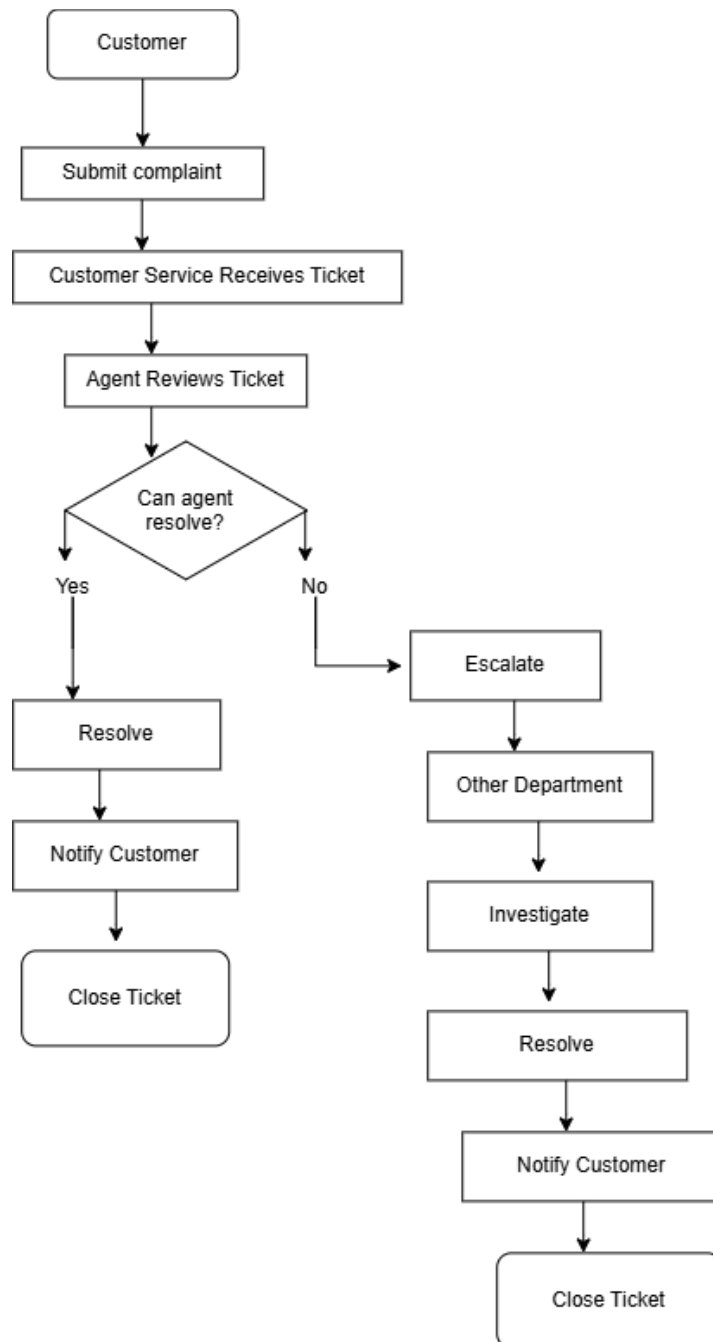
6.2 Current Process Problems

Problem	Impact
Manual ticket assignment	Tickets may reach the wrong team
No consistent escalation rules	Unnecessary escalations
Limited customer information	Agents spend time requesting information
Poor SLA visibility	Tickets may become overdue
Manual communication	Customers may not receive timely updates
Multiple departments involved	Longer resolution times

6.3 Key Observation

The current process contains several manual steps and relies on employees to determine ticket priority, assignment, and escalation. These activities contribute to delays and inconsistent customer service outcomes.

Figure 1: Current Customer Service Process (As-Is)



7. To-Be Process

7.1 Improved Customer Service Process

The proposed process introduces automated ticket categorisation, priority assignment, routing, and SLA monitoring.

Proposed Process Flow

1. Customer submits support ticket

↓

2. System creates ticket number

↓

3. System automatically categorises ticket

↓

4. System assigns ticket priority

↓

5. System routes ticket to the appropriate department

↓

6. Agent reviews ticket and customer/order information

↓

7. Can the agent resolve the issue?

YES → Resolve issue → Notify customer → Close ticket

NO → Escalate according to SLA rules → Specialist team investigates → Resolve issue → Notify customer → Close ticket

7.2 Improvements

(See the detailed area-by-area comparison in section 7.4.)

7.3 Expected Outcome

The improved process should reduce manual work, improve ticket routing, reduce resolution times, minimise unnecessary escalations, and provide customers with faster and more consistent support.

7.4 Process Improvement Summary

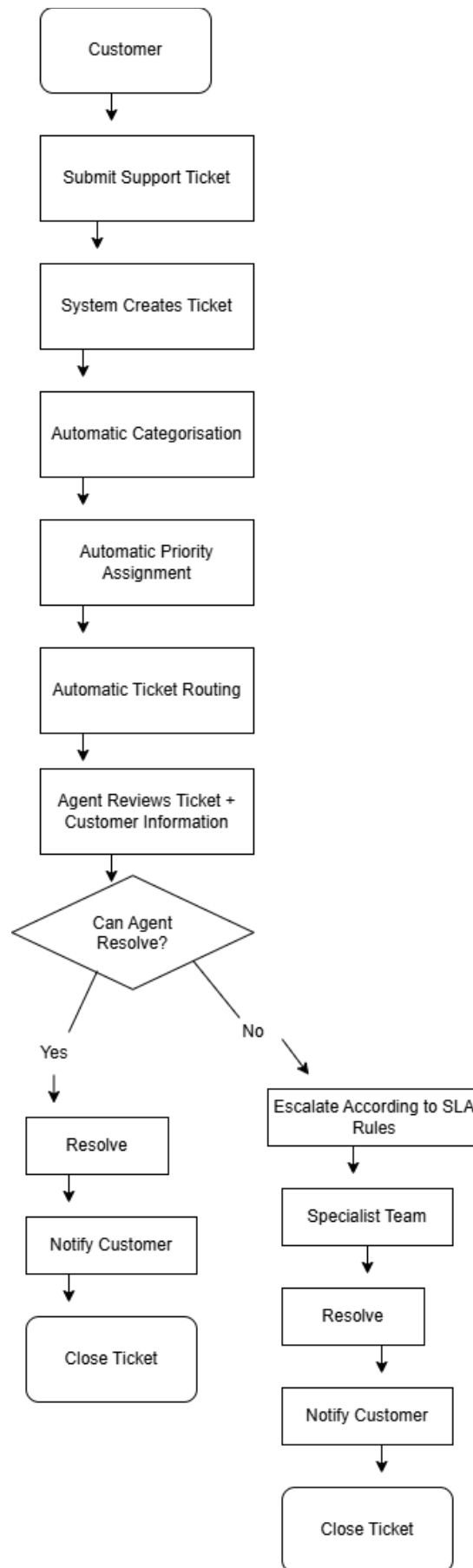
The proposed To-Be process improves the current customer service process by introducing automation and standardised decision-making.

Area	Current Process	Improved Process
Ticket creation	Manual	Automated
Categorisation	Manual	Automatic
Priority	Inconsistent	Standardised
Routing	Manual	Automatic
Customer information	Limited	Available to agent
SLA monitoring	Manual	Automated
Escalation	Inconsistent	SLA-based
Reporting	Limited	Automated

Expected Improvement

The redesigned process should reduce manual effort, improve ticket routing, accelerate issue resolution, and provide better visibility of customer service performance.

Figure 2: Proposed Customer Service Process (To-Be)



8. Business Rules

The following business rules will govern the improved customer service process.

ID	Business Rule
BR-001	Every customer support request must receive a unique ticket number.
BR-002	Every ticket must have a category before it can be assigned to an agent.
BR-003	Every ticket must be assigned a priority based on the severity of the customer's issue.
BR-004	Tickets must be routed to the department responsible for resolving the issue.
BR-005	Critical tickets must be escalated immediately to the appropriate supervisor.
BR-006	Tickets approaching their SLA deadline must trigger an alert to the responsible team.
BR-007	Only authorised employees may access customer and order information.
BR-008	A ticket may only be closed after the customer's issue has been resolved or an approved resolution has been provided.
BR-009	All ticket status changes must be recorded for audit purposes.
BR-010	Customers must be notified when there is a significant change to their ticket status.

8.1 Priority Rules

Priority	Example	Response Target
Critical	Payment issue preventing an order from being completed	< 1 hour
High	Failed delivery or incorrect order	< 4 hours
Medium	Product information or general complaint	< 8 hours

Priority	Example	Response Target
Low	General enquiry or feedback	< 24 hours

9. KPIs & Success Measures

The following Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) will be used to measure the success of the improved customer service process.

KPI	Current	Target	Purpose
Average Response Time	18 hrs	< 6 hrs	Measure how quickly customers receive an initial response
Average Resolution Time	42 hrs	< 24 hrs	Measure how quickly customer issues are resolved
First-Contact Resolution	54%	75%	Measure how many issues are resolved without escalation
Escalation Rate	22%	< 10%	Measure unnecessary ticket escalations
Customer Satisfaction	71%	≥ 85%	Measure customer experience
SLA Compliance	70%	≥ 95%	Measure whether tickets are resolved within agreed times
Unresolved Tickets	1,500/month	< 500/month	Measure the outstanding support workload

9.1 Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if:

- Average response time is reduced to less than 6 hours.
- Average resolution time is reduced to less than 24 hours.
- First-contact resolution reaches at least 75%.
- Escalation rate falls below 10%.

- Customer satisfaction reaches at least 85%.
- SLA compliance reaches at least 95%.
- Unresolved tickets are reduced significantly.

9.2 Measurement Approach

Performance will be monitored through customer service reports and dashboards. KPI results will be reviewed regularly by the Customer Service Team Leader and Operations Manager to identify further improvement opportunities.

10. Test Cases

Test cases are used to verify that the proposed customer service solution meets the defined requirements.

Test ID	Requirement	Test Scenario	Expected Result
TC-001	FR-001	Customer submits a support ticket	Ticket is created and a unique ticket number is generated
TC-002	FR-002	Customer submits a ticket with a known issue type	System automatically assigns the correct category
TC-003	FR-003	Customer submits a critical issue	System assigns Critical priority
TC-004	FR-004	Ticket is created for a delivery issue	Ticket is routed to the appropriate department
TC-005	FR-005	Agent opens a customer ticket	Customer and relevant order information is displayed
TC-006	FR-006	Agent updates ticket status	New status is saved successfully
TC-007	FR-007	Ticket status changes	Customer receives a notification
TC-008	FR-008	Ticket approaches its SLA deadline	Supervisor receives an SLA warning

Test ID	Requirement	Test Scenario	Expected Result
TC-009	FR-009	Supervisor opens ticket dashboard	Unresolved and escalated tickets are visible
TC-010	FR-010	Manager requests a performance report	System generates the required customer service metrics

10.1 Example Detailed Test Case

TC-003 — Critical Ticket Priority

Requirement: FR-003

Scenario: A customer submits a critical payment issue.

Given: The customer is submitting a support ticket.

When: The issue is classified as a critical payment problem.

Then: The system should automatically assign the ticket a **Critical** priority.

Expected Result:

The ticket is assigned Critical priority and follows the appropriate response and escalation rules.

Status: Not Tested

11. Requirements Traceability Matrix

The Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) ensures that each requirement can be traced from its original business need through to testing.

Requirement ID	Requirement	User Story	Test Case	Priority	Status
FR-001	Customer can submit support tickets	US-001	TC-001	High	Not Tested
FR-002	Tickets are automatically categorised	US-002	TC-002	High	Not Tested
FR-003	Tickets receive priority levels	US-001	TC-003	High	Not Tested

Requirement ID	Requirement	User Story	Test Case	Priority	Status
FR-004	Tickets are routed to the correct department	US-004	TC-004	High	Not Tested
FR-005	Agents can view customer/order information	US-003	TC-005	High	Not Tested
FR-006	Agents can update ticket status	US-001	TC-006	High	Not Tested
FR-007	Customers receive status notifications	US-001	TC-007	Medium	Not Tested
FR-008	Supervisors receive SLA alerts	US-005	TC-008	High	Not Tested
FR-009	Supervisors can view unresolved tickets	US-004	TC-009	High	Not Tested
FR-010	System generates performance reports	N/A (system-only)	TC-010	Medium	Not Tested

11.1 Traceability

The RTM provides a clear connection between:

Requirement → User Story → Test Case

This helps ensure that important requirements are not missed during development and testing.

12. Risk Analysis

The following risks have been identified for the proposed customer service improvement project, along with recommended mitigations.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Agents resist new automated workflows and revert to manual habits	Medium	High	Provide training and a phased rollout; involve agents in UAT before go-live

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Automatic categorisation misclassifies tickets, causing incorrect routing	Medium	Medium	Allow agents to manually reassign tickets; monitor categorisation accuracy during early rollout
Customer and order data quality issues undermine agent decision-making	Low	High	Run a data-cleansing pass on customer/order records before go-live
SLA targets prove unrealistic once automation is live, causing false breach alerts	Medium	Medium	Review SLA targets against pilot-phase data before full rollout

13. Final Recommendation

13.1 Recommended Solution

Ubuntu Retail should implement an improved customer service management process supported by automated ticket categorisation, priority assignment, ticket routing, SLA monitoring, customer notifications, and performance reporting.

The proposed solution addresses the main weaknesses identified in the current process and provides customer service teams with better visibility and more efficient tools.

13.2 Expected Business Benefits

The proposed solution is expected to:

- Reduce customer response and resolution times.
- Increase first-contact resolution.
- Reduce unnecessary escalations.
- Improve SLA compliance.
- Increase customer satisfaction.
- Reduce manual administrative work.
- Improve visibility of customer service performance.
- Provide management with reliable performance data.

13.3 Implementation Priorities

The recommended implementation should prioritise:

Phase 1 — Core Ticket Management

- Ticket creation
- Ticket categorisation
- Priority assignment
- Ticket routing

Phase 2 — Customer Service Improvements

- Customer/order information
- Customer notifications
- SLA monitoring
- Escalation management

Phase 3 — Reporting & Optimisation

- KPI dashboards
- Performance reporting
- Process monitoring
- Continuous improvement

13.4 Conclusion

The analysis indicates that Ubuntu Retail's current customer service process can be significantly improved through automation, standardised business rules, better access to information, and improved performance monitoring.

The proposed solution is aligned with the company's objectives of improving operational efficiency and customer satisfaction. Success should be measured against the defined KPIs and reviewed regularly to identify additional opportunities for improvement.